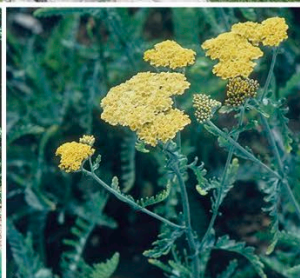
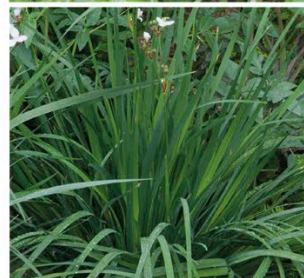


USING PLANT TYPES TO CREATE A DESIGN

When creating a design, look at the structure and habit of the plants you have selected, as well as their flowers, and consider the role each will play in your scheme. Start by planning the position of permanent structural plants, such as trees and shrubs, which will form the main framework of your design and lend a sense of solidity. Then, add in seasonal plants to

create a sequence of color and interest throughout the year, and midrange perennials to fill gaps between the structural elements. Focal plants with eye-catching shapes or colors, such as spiky irises or shrubs with dramatic leaves, provide highlights in a border, while those with spreading stems cover bare soil with a carpet of foliage and flowers.

Balancing shape and form This summer border shows how different plant forms can be used to create a harmonious display.



Focal points Spiky grasses and vertical perennials draw the eye and can be used to punctuate a border.

Midrange plants Use perennials and small shrubs to knit together seasonal flowers and larger plants.

Structural plants Create a permanent framework with well-placed evergreen and deciduous trees and shrubs.

Seasonal plants Sustain interest throughout the year by including a range of seasonal plants and flowers.

Ground cover Plants with spreading stems help to fill gaps in a border and can suppress weed growth too.